SEEK in the Adaptive RAG Design Space

A concise comparison of where retrieval is decided, what signal it uses, and how interpretable that decision is.

Method	Decision unit	Retrieval signal	Decision transparency
Adaptive-RAG	Question	Complexity classifier	**Medium**
FLARE	Token / Sentence	Token probability	**High**
DeepRAG	Sub-question	Learned policy	**Low**
SEEK (Ours)	**Sub-question**	**Tail leakage + verifier**	**High**

SEEK is the only method here that combines sub-question decisions with an explicit, interpretable confidence signal.

Granularity tells us where the decision happens; transparency tells us whether that decision can be inspected and explained.